

Cornell Policy Group

Inaugural Policy Symposium

Wednesday, April 22, 2026 · 5:00 – 7:00 PM · Gates Hall G01

OVERVIEW

The Cornell Policy Group is proud to host its inaugural Policy Symposium, showcasing select research and policy work produced by our six policy centers. The evening will feature student presentations on topics spanning domestic policy, economics, education, foreign policy, health, the environment, and technology – followed by a dinner reception.

EVENT SCHEDULE

4:30 PM

Light Refreshments

Pre-event refreshments available for early arrivals

5:00 PM

Welcome & Opening Remarks

5 min

5:05 PM — Student Presentations (approx. 10 min each)

~5:05 PM

Center for Domestic Policy

Overview: The Center for Domestic Policy addresses pressing national issues by analyzing and proposing solutions in areas such as social welfare, criminal justice, and housing.

Topics: *Teacher Housing in High-Needs Districts · Expanding the National School Lunch Program to Include Weekend Food Packs · Increasing Language Access for LEP Individuals · Justice Reinvestment for Public Defense Caseload Limits · Protecting Musical Likeness in the AI Era · Public Healthcare Systems for Immigration Detention Centers · Strengthening Enforcement Against Iranian Shadow Fleets*

Members: Avery Prince,* Sam Stille,* Quinn Friedman, Arrow Peretz, Ryan Morehead, Lizzie Fine, Emily Snider, Annelie Chang, Alanna Dorelien, Andrew Dachnowicz, Cole Laudenslager, Rachel Baron

~5:15 PM

Center for Education Policy

Overview: The Center for Education Policy has tackled pressing issues in the American education system, ranging from grading reform and campus security concerns to food insecurity, youth literacy, health education, and teacher shortages.

Members: Rohith Tsundupalli,* Kiran Chaudhry-Bishop,* Sejal Sekhar, Abby Silverman, Reagan Allvin, Samara Schiffman, Ben Nusbaum, Francesca Wehner, Jackson Hunley, Ella Nguyen



Topics: *Straight-Average Semesterly Grading in Maryland · Reshaping Sexual Geographies & Campus Safety · Subsidizing Afterschool Programming in Virginia · Statewide Community Eligibility & Child Food Insecurity · Evidence-Based Reading Reform & Youth Literacy · Comprehensive Sex Education in Virginia · Federal Incentives & the CTE Teacher Shortage · Mental Health Training Mandates for School Staff*

~5:25 PM

Center for Economic Policy

Overview: The Center for Economic Policy has addressed key issues of affordability and consumer protection from multiple lenses, including student-athlete regulations, housing policy, welfare policy, and gambling regulations.

Topics: *Ending Single Family Zoning in Chicago · Banning Transfer Buyout Clauses in NIL Deals · Managing the Risky Economic Behavior of Consumer Participation in Prediction Markets · Ending the Drug Felony SNAP Ban in South Carolina · A Land Value Tax for California*

Members: Aryan Shah,* Adam Azevedo,* Anand Patel, Raghav Raj, Casey Wu, Alana Treviño

~5:35 PM

Center for Environment & Technology Policy

Overview: At a moment when science and technology policy are under unprecedented pressure, EnviroTech spotlights student research spanning AI ethics, climate communications, space regulation, labor markets, public health, and agricultural innovation, demonstrating the sheer breadth and variety of what environment and technology policy touches.

Topics: *Satellite Megaconstellations & Light Pollution · Climate Communications & Hope-Based Messaging · Climate Communications & Hope-Based Messaging · Ghost Jobs & Gen Z Labor Markets · AI Surveillance & Crimmigration · Climate-Adaptive Viticulture in the Finger Lakes · EHR Environmental Feeds & Public Health · Climate Education in K-4 Curricula · Domestic Food Waste Reform*

Members: Kashyap Rajesh,* Finn Woodman,* Alix Kerebel, Jack Turner, Kevin Chang, Thamarie Pinnaduwege, Will Dignam, Krislyn Michel, Sahaj Satani, Sage Geubtner

~5:45 PM

Center for Health Policy

Overview: From rising costs to gaps in healthcare oversight, the U.S. healthcare system faces growing structural challenges. The Center for Health Policy explores policy solutions across multiple sectors of healthcare to improve accountability, access, and preparedness.

Topics: *Clinician Burnout & Mental Health Access · Medicare Advantage Payment Integrity · Correctional Healthcare Oversight · Public Health Emergency Preparedness*

Members: Kimia Shahriyar,* Tanirika Choudhry,* Arjun Anugole, Asha Gandreti, Ava Boris, Kaitlyn Varriale, Keshav Mopati, KJ Williams, Lilia Mitra, Merrick Word-Brown, Ruth Fan, Sophie Rinzler.

~5:55 PM

Center for Foreign Policy

Overview: The Center for Foreign Policy has examined the theme of 'security' across multiple lenses, from environmental security to safety from gang violence.

Topics: *The United States' Two-Pronged Approach to Combat Haitian Gangs · Reforming Assurances of Private Water Rights to Reclaim Water Security for Chilean Communities · Expanding Migrant Workers' Rights in Qatar by Repealing Absconding Laws · Salvadoran President Nayib Bukele's "Mano Duro" Policy is an Iron Fist Destroying Human Rights in El Salvador*



Members: Zaki Ahmad,* Jorge Mariño,* Quinton Baldis, Suhani Chalwa, Annika Joseph, Harrison Keyser, Zachary Mangoba, Madeline Shukovsky

6:05 PM

Senior Recognition

Recognizing senior analysts

6:20 PM

Dinner Reception

Dinner service and open networking · Room until 7:00 PM

PRESENTING CENTERS

Center for Domestic Policy	Center for Education Policy
Center for Economic Policy	Center for Foreign Policy
Center for Health Policy	Center for Environment & Technology Policy

Explore CPG

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